

» CHAMPIONS TROPHY PHOTOLINE



1998: Originally called the ICC Knockout Trophy, its first edition took place in Bangladesh in 1998. Designed to promote cricket among non-Test-playing nations it also aimed at generating funds between World Cups. After defeating India in the semifinal, West Indies faced South Africa in the final. Despite a fighting century from opener Philo Wallace, the tournament's leading run-scorer, West Indies fell short. South Africa emerged victorious, securing its first-ever ICC trophy. GETTYIMAGES

2000: The 2000 final in Nairobi was defined by two standout centuries — one from Sourav Ganguly and the other from Chris Cairns (**in pic**). In a thrilling contest, New Zealand edged past India by four wickets with just two balls to spare. India got off to a strong start with a 141-run opening partnership between Ganguly and Sachin Tendulkar but could only post 264. During the chase, New Zealand found themselves in trouble at 132/5, until the rescue act by Cairns took them home. Ganguly finished as the tournament's top run-scorer, while Venkatesh Prasad claimed the most wickets. GETTYIMAGES

